

poems by JOHN ASHBERY

the
tennis
court
oath

Boullinghouse

ALSO BY JOHN ASHBERY

Turandot and Other Poems (Tibor de Nagy Editions, New York, 1953)

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the

A BOOK OF

tennis

POEMS BY

court

JOHN ASHBERY

oath

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to Pierre Martory

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THE TENNIS COURT OATH

What had you been thinking about
the face studiously bloodied
heaven blotted region
I go on loving you like water but
there is a terrible breath in the way all of this
You were not elected president, yet won the race
All the way through fog and drizzle
When you read it was sincere the coasts
stammered with unintentional villages the
horse strains fatigued I guess . . . the calls . . .
I worry

the water beetle head
why of course reflecting all
then you redid you were breathing
I thought going down to mail this
of the kettle you jabbered as easily in the yard
you come through but
are incomparable the lovely tent
mystery you don't want surrounded the real
you dance
in the spring there was clouds

The mulatress approached in the hall—the
lettering easily visible along the edge of the *Times*
in a moment the bell would ring but there was time
for the carnation laughed here are a couple of "other"

to one in yon house

The doctor and Philip had come over the road
Turning in toward the corner of the wall his hat on
reading it carelessly as if to tell you your fears were justified
the blood shifted you know those walls
wind off the earth had made him shrink
undeniably an oboe now the young
were there there was candy
to decide the sharp edge of the garment
like a particular cry not intervening called the dog "he's coming! he's
coming" with an emotion felt it sink into peace

there was no turning back but the end was in sight
he chose this moment to ask her in detail about her family and the others
The person. pleaded—"have more of these
not stripes on the tunic—or the porch chairs
will teach you about men—what it means"
to be one in a million pink stripe
and now could go away the three approached the doghouse
the reef. Your daughter's
dream of my son understand prejudice
darkness in the hole
the patient finished
They could all go home now the hole was dark
lilacs blowing across his face glad he brought you

They dream only of America
To be lost among the thirteen million pillars of grass:
"This honey is delicious
Though it burns the throat."

And hiding from darkness in barns
They can be grownups now
And the murderer's ash tray is more easily—
The lake a lilac cube.

He holds a key in his right hand.
"Please," he asked willingly.
He is thirty years old.
That was before

We could drive hundreds of miles
At night through dandelions.
When his headache grew worse we
Stopped at a wire filling station.

Now he cared only about signs.
Was the cigar a sign?
And what about the key?
He went slowly into the bedroom.

"I would not have broken my leg if I had not fallen
Against the living room table. What is it to be back
Beside the bed? There is nothing to do
For our liberation, except wait in the horror of it.

And I am lost without you."

"It is such a beautiful day I had to write you a letter
From the tower, and to show I'm not mad:
I only slipped on the cake of soap of the air
And drowned in the bathtub of the world.
You were too good to cry much over me.
And now I let you go. Signed, The Dwarf."

I passed by late in the afternoon
And the smile still played about her lips
As it has for centuries. She always knows
How to be utterly delightful. Oh my daughter,
My sweetheart, daughter of my late employer, princess,
May you not be long on the way!

1.

Piling upward
the fact the stars
In America the office hid
archives in his
stall . . .
Enormous stars on them
The cold anarchist standing
in his hat.
Arm along the rail
We were parked
Millions of us
The accident was terrible.
The way the door swept out
The stones piled up—
The ribbon—books. miracle. with moon and the stars

The pear tree
moving me
I am around and in my sigh
The gift of a the stars.
The person
Horror—the morsels of his choice
Rebuked to me I
—in the apartment
the pebble we in the bed.
The roof—
rain— pills—
Found among the moss
Hers wouldn't longer care—I don't know why.

2.

Ribbons
over the Pacific
Sometimes we
The deep
additional
and more and more less deep

but hurting
under the fire
brilliant rain
to meet us.
Probably in
moulded fire
We make it
times of the year
the light falls from heaven
love
parting the separate lives
her fork the
specs
notably fire.
We get unhappy, off
The love
All the house
Waste visits
Autumn brushes the hair
The girl has lived in this corner
In the sunlight all year.
getting up to speak
Your janitor tried
if it was ready
I was almost killed
now by reading
on trial
standing with the jar
in the door wrapper
of this year fire intangible
Spoon
glad the dirt around
the geraniums of last August's
dried in the yard
played for certain
person
of course the lathes around
the stars with privilege jerks
over the country last year we were disgusted meeting
misguided
their only answer pine tree
off of the land

to the wind
 out of your medicine
 health, light, death preoccupation, beauty.
 So don't kill the
 stone this is desert
 to the arms
 You girl
 the sea in waves.

3.

of the arsenal
 shaded in public
 a hand put up
 lips—a house
 A minute the music stops.
 The day it began. Person
 blocking the conductor
 Is the janitor with the red cape
 And the pot of flowers in one hand
 His face hidden by the shelf
 thought intangible.
 So is this way
 out into the paths
 of the square
 petals armed with a chain
 arctic night
 what with stars
 rocks and that fascinating illumination
 that buries my heart
 itself a tribune for which dancers
 come. Inch pageant
 of history shaping
 More than the forms
 can do quacks
 the night over the baths
 stirred in his sleep the janitor reaches for the wrench
 with which he'll kill the intruder
 Terrain
 Glistening
 Doesn't resemble much the out of doors
 We walked around the hand
 observe the smashing of the rain

into the door the night
 can't keep inside
 perhaps feeling the sentry
 the perfect disc
 We walked toward the bush
 the disc
 something was the matter with the disc
 bush had forgotten
 apples on the crater
 the northern
 Messenger the snow
 stone

4.

Though I had never come here
 This country, its laws of glass
 And night majesty
 Through the football
 Lured far away
 Wave helplessly
 The country
 lined with snow
 only mush was served
 piling up
 the undesired stars
 needed against the night
 Forbidden categorically
 but admitted
 beyond the cape
 the tree still grows
 tears fall
 And I am proud
 of these stars in our flag we don't want
 the flag of film
 waving over the sky
 toward us—citizens of some future state.
 We despair in the room, but the stars
 And night persist, knowing we don't want it
 Some tassels first
 then nothing—day
 the odor.
 In the hall. The stone.

Across the other sea, was
 in progress
 the halt sea
 Tens of persons blinded
 Immediately the port, challenge
 Argument
 Pear tree
 Only perforation
 Chain to fall apart in his hand
 Someday liberty
 to be of the press
 drank
 perhaps the lotion
 she added. Drank
 the orders.
 The fake
 ones.
 border
 his misanthropy. pear mist.
 the act imitation
 his happy stance
 position peace
 on earth
 ignited fluid
 before he falls
 must come under this head
 be liked, so may be
 Tears, hopeless adoration, passions
 the fruit of carpentered night
 Visible late next day. Cars
 blockade the streets wish
 the geraniums embracing
 umbrella
 falling his embrace he strangles
 in his storage but in
 this meant
 one instance
 A feather not snow blew against the window.
 A signal from the great outside.

1. DIDO

The body's products become
Fatal to it. Our spit
Would kill us, but we
Die of our heat.
Though I say the things I wish to say
They are needless, their own flame conceives it.
So I am cheated of perfection.

The iodine bottle sat in the hall
And out over the park where crawled roadsters
The apricot and purple clouds were
And our blood flowed down the grating
Of the cream-colored embassy.
Inside it they had a record of "The St. Louis Blues."

2. THE IDIOT

O how this sullen, careless world
Ignorant of me is! Those rocks, those homes
Know not the touch of my flesh, nor is there one tree
Whose shade has known me for a friend.
I've wandered the wide world over.
No man I've known, no friendly beast
Has come and put its nose into my hands.
No maid has welcomed my face with a kiss.

Yet once, as I took passage
From Gibraltar to Cape Horn
I met some friendly mariners on the boat
And as we struggled to keep the ship from sinking
The very waves seemed friendly, and the sound
The spray made as it hit the front of the boat.

To true roses uplifted on the bilious tide of evening
And morning-glories dotting the crescent day
The oval shape responds:
My first is a haunting face
In the hanging-down hair.
My second is water:
I am a sieve.

My only new thing:
The penalty of light forever
Over the heads of those who were there
And back into the night, the cough of the finishing petal.

Once approved the magenta must continue
But the bark island sees
Into the light:
It grieves for what it gives:
Tears that streak the dusty firmament.

The evening I offer you the easy aspirin of death
 Boots on the golden age of landscape
 You don't understand when I've
 Smelled the smell of . . . I don't know
 Now from opposite sides of the drawing
 The nut of his birthday

Bringing night brings in also idea of death
 Thought when she was sixteen . . . he'd take her out
 But it did no good . . . Fuss was
 Over the comics like in board you seen
 Growing in patch on them laurels. And after
 Taken out behind the stairs and stood them
 In the kitchen . . . the flowers blowing in the window
 Felt funny just the same . . . on account of the stove
 We moved to another place. Funny how eighteen years can make
 All that difference . . . the marble
 We never wanted to go away
 But the porch forced its way on
 Acting kind of contented in the silvery wind
 From who knows where . . . the porcelain
 Uh huh.

It was sometime after this
 We were all sitting alone one night
 One stops did you hear the colored flute
 Brand of years tossed into ash can
 The heap of detritus . . . tickets to the bed
 Detective women the entire scene
 We'll make sides.

They stop for a moment.
 His landlord turned him out
 It a hot dog stand

.....
 Was grown chilly
 My brain concocted
 It did the inspector
 He had been wandering
 Around the park in a delirium

After the fang had grown
 Add dishes returned—flowers on them
 Neutral daylight sitting things
 Like it. It woofed. It liked it.

Ordeal a home and
 My lake and sat down
 We must the gin came faster in cups
 Under the scissors mill just like you was sixteen
 In the orange flowers a pale narcissus hung
 You was saying the alligators the grove
 And he plied a rod out of the gray
 Fishing manure . . . the gray roses the best
 And the bed hung with violets
 I was rampant to ask you she had been would circulate
 The prisons . . .
 Out of the storeroom never to
 Back in the room they for the six weeks
 Piercing the monocle . . . because letters
 The sad trash newspapers schedule complaint
 To belong to me

It strikes me . . . the robe loose
 The overalls laying . . .
 Gray and . . . flimsy. You the cake
 Hobbled over to get the and grand
 Store out of peanuts dust his thin
 Cane down near store and the powder
 Under the runway where a little
 Light falls just on the patch
 Noise that thought came from his own leg
 There are numerous
 Distinct flavors
 The peanut ship wells
 Into the desert
 The stand . . . Velocipede
 Pergolas next to the chance of numb hitting
 In the rostrum he forgot the behind him
 Murmur halls on half-wet beauty
 Paper green big
 Sense
 Where the trout had originated from

Smuggled from youth and grown into a tree
Fallen halfway across house
To bring the pet
Over the flowered curtains around
Water capillaries magic
Lift on the dune . . . screaming her part dumb

They vary, depending
Salmon left the sea, gradually to
Pale and watery
But he will never to the fly
It is dumb and night continually seeping up—like a reservoir
Of truth on the bandits
He asked the fish why she seemed to . . .
A jeweler's, smooth, and luggage
Next day beside the rail
Arranged for night the postman bent down
Delivered his stare into the grass
I guess the darkness stubbed its toe

We were growing away from that . . . waiting
The pool of shade
Near the dress house . . . and she turned in
The fly beckon on the window
The kids came and we all went the briars.

How much longer will I be able to inhabit the divine sepulcher
Of life, my great love? Do dolphins plunge bottomward
To find the light? Or is it rock
That is searched? Unrelentingly? Huh. And if some day

Men with orange shovels come to break open the rock
Which encases me, what about the light that comes in then?
What about the smell of the light?
What about the moss?

In pilgrim times he wounded me
Since then I only lie
My bed of light is a furnace choking me
With hell (and sometimes I hear salt water dripping).

I mean it—because I'm one of the few
To have held my breath under the house. I'll trade
One red sucker for two blue ones. I'm
Named Tom. The

Light bounces off mossy rocks down to me
In this glen (the neat villa! which
When he'd had he would not had he of
And jests under the smarting of privet

Which on hot spring nights perfumes the empty rooms
With the smell of sperm flushed down toilets
On hot summer afternoons within sight of the sea.
If you knew why then professor) reads

To his friends: Drink to me only with
And the reader is carried away
By a great shadow under the sea.
Behind the steering wheel

The boy took out his own forehead.
His girlfriend's head was a green bag
Of narcissus stems. "OK you win
But meet me anyway at Cohen's Drug Store

In 22 minutes." What a marvel is ancient man!
 Under the tulip roots he has figured out a way to be a religious animal
 And would be a mathematician. But where in unsuitable heaven
 Can he get the heat that will make him grow?

For he needs something or will forever remain a dwarf,
 Though a perfect one, and possessing a normal-sized brain
 But he has got to be released by giants from things.
 And as the plant grows older it realizes it will never be a tree,

Will probably always be haunted by a bee
 And cultivates stupid impressions
 So as not to become part of the dirt. The dirt
 Is mounting like a sea. And we say goodbye

Shaking hands in front of the crashing of the waves
 That give our words lonesomeness, and make these flabby hands seem
 ours—

Hands that are always writing things
 On mirrors for people to see later—

Do you want them to water
 Plant, tear listlessly among the exchangeable ivy—
 Carrying food to mouth, touching genitals—
 But no doubt you have understood

It all now and I am a fool. It remains
 For me to get better, and to understand you so
 Like a chair-sized man. Boots
 Were heard on the floor above. In the garden the sunlight was still purple

But what buzzed in it had changed slightly
 But not forever . . . but casting its shadow
 On sticks, and looking around for an opening in the air, was quite as if it
 had never refused to exist differently. Guys
 In the yard handled the belt he had made

Stars
 Painted the garage roof crimson and black
 He is not a man
 Who can read these signs . . . his bones were stays . . .

And even refused to live
In a world and refunded the hiss
Of all that exists terribly near us
Like you, my love, and light.

For what is obedience but the air around us
To the house? For which the federal men came
In a minute after the sidewalk
Had taken you home? ("Latin . . . blossom . . .")

After which you led me to water
And bade me drink, which I did, owing to your kindness.
You would not let me out for two days and three nights,
Bringing me books bound in wild thyme and scented wild grasses

As if reading had any interest for me, you . . .
Now you are laughing.
Darkness interrupts my story.
Turn on the light.

Meanwhile what am I going to do?
I am growing up again, in school, the crisis will be very soon.
And you twist the darkness in your fingers, you
Who are slightly older . . .

Who are you, anyway?
And it is the color of sand,
The darkness, as it sifts through your hand
Because what does anything mean,

The ivy and the sand? That boat
Pulled up on the shore? Am I wonder,
Strategically, and in the light
Of the long sepulcher that hid death and hides me?

I.

The spoon of your head
crossed by livid stems

The chestnuts' large clovers wiped

You see only the white page its faint frame of red
You hear the viola's death sound
A woman sits in black and white tile

Why, you are pale

Light sucks up what I did
In the room two months ago
Spray of darkness across the back,
Tree flowers . . .

Taxis took us far apart
And will . . .

over the shuddering page of a sea
The sofa

Hay
blown in the window
The boards dark as night sea
Pot of flowers fixed in the wind

Last year . . . the gray snow falling
The building . . . pictures
His eye into the forest

And people alright
Those stiff lead rods
Silver in the afternoon light
Near where it stops
Where they drink tea from a glass smaller than a thimble
Head of shade

And many stiff little weeds that grew

beside the kidney-shaped lake
A wooden cage painted green
sand

And the green streets though parallel run
far from each other

Cupped under the small lead surface of that cloud you see you are
going to die
Burnt by the powder of that view

The day of the week will not save you

Mixture of air and wind
Sand then mud
A flower, lost in someone's back yard.

11.

The first coffee of the morning
Soon the stars.

and broken feldspar black
squares against the light
message—a handwriting
Dip pen in solution

They would be playing now
The sky
Flowers sucked in—stone rhinunculus
amaryllis—red
Freesia and existence

The letter arrives—seeing the stamp
The van
New York under the umbrella

A photograph of what

Fumes
Features in the lake
The light
The shadow of a hand
soft on the lock

staring wax
 scraped with a pin, reflection of the face
 The time
 principal thing
 Train
 Hand holding watch
 silver vase
 against the plaid

Comfort me

The hedge coming up to meet me that way in the dried red sun
The meadows down I mean
At night
Curious—I'd seen this tall girl

I urge the deep prune of the mirror
That stick she carries
The book—a trap

The facts have hinged on my reply

calm
Hat against the sky
Eyes of forest

memory of cars
You buried in the hot avenue: and to all of them, you cannot be and are,
naming me.

III.

The missing letter—the crumb of confidence
 His love boiling up to me
 Forever will I be the only
 In sofa I know
 The darkness on his back
 Fleeing to darkness of my side

It is the time
We do not live in but on
And this young man
like a soldier

Into the dust
 Words drip from the wound
 Spring mounts in me
 of dandelion—lots of it

And the little one
 the hooded lost one
 near the pillow

A fine young man

IV.

The storm coming—
 Not to have ever been exactly on this street with cats
 Because the houses were vanishing behind a cloud
 The plants on the rugs look nice
 Yet I have never been here before

Glass

regime

Which is in the tepee of the great city
 I build to you every moment
 Ice lily of the sewers
 In a thousand thoughts
 Mindful in a thousand dresser drawers you pull out
 Mufti of the gray crocus silent on the wood diamond floor
 Or if I asked you for a game with rods and balls
 You stood up with me to play

But fatal laxity undoes
 The stiff, dark and busy streets
 Through which any help must roll.
 The third of runners who are upon are past you
 The opal snows the moppet
 You behind me in the van
 The flat sea rushing away

And if he thought that
All was foreign—
As, gas and petrol, en-
gine full of seeds, barking to hear the night
The political contaminations

Of what he spoke,
Spotted azaleas brought to meet him
Sitting next day
The judge, emotions,
The crushed paper heaps.

The arctic honey blabbed over the report causing darkness
 And pulling us out of there experiencing it
 he meanwhile . . . And the fried bats they sell there
 dropping from sticks, so that the menace of your prayer folds . . .
 Other people . . . flash
 the garden are you boning
 and defunct covering . . . Blind dog expressed royalties . . .
 comfort of your perfect tar grams nuclear world bank tulip
 Favorable to near the night pin
 loading formaldehyde. the table torn from you
 Suddenly and we are close
 Mouthing the root when you think
 generator homes enjoy leered

The worn stool blazing pigeons from the roof
 driving tractor to squash
 Leaving the Atocha Station steel
 infected bumps the screws
 everywhere wells
 abolished top ill-lit
 scarecrow falls Time, progress and good sense
 strike of shopkeepers dark blood
 no forest you can name drunk scrolls
 the completely new Italian hair . . .
 Baby . . . ice falling off the port
 The centennial Before we can

old eat
 members with their chins
 so high up rats
 relaxing the cruel discussion
 suds the painted corners
 white most aerial
 garment crow
 and when the region took us back
 the person left us like birds
 it was fuzz on the passing light
 over disgusted heads, far into amnesiac
 permanent house depot amounts he can
 decrepit mayor . . . exalting flea

The worst side of it all—
The white sunlight on the polished floor—
Pressed into service,
And then the window closed
And the night ends and begins again.
Her face goes green, her eyes are green;
In the dark corner playing "The Stars and Stripes Forever." I try
to describe for you,
But you will not listen, you are like the swan.

No stars are there,
No stripes,
But a blind man's cane poking, however clumsily, into the inmost
corners of the house.
Nothing can be harmed! Night and day are beginning again!
So put away the book,
The flowers you were keeping to give someone:
Only the white, tremendous foam of the street has any importance,
The new white flowers that are beginning to shoot up about now.

She is under heavy sedation
 Seeing the world. The drink
 Controls the tooth
 Weather information clinic
 Tomorrow morning. She started
 On her round-the-world cruise
 Aboard the *Zephyr*. The boy sport
 A dress. The girl,
 Slacks. Each carried a magazine—
 A package of sea the observatory
 Introduced me to canned you.
 Only a few cases of plague
 Announced in Oporto, the schools
 Reopen in the fresh September breeze.
 Teeth are munching salads
 Tragedy and forest fires return
 To the pitted, happy town.
 A jungle of matter
 Floats over the piles.
 A major insulted the naval
 Doom. The buttons' pill
 Descended the trunk with a shout.
 Servitude leapt from old age. Sky
 Imagined us happy. The black
 Trees impinged on the balloon. It follows
 We were mean subsequently
 To those who were near us,
 The nude sleeping mechanically,
 The foundation boy under the plant.
 You tittered that in the milady of rocks
 The sea was expanding neutral.
 The stair carpet plunged into blankness.

"The igloo sun, while I was away,
 Chastened the wolverine towels.
 Isn't Idaho the wolverine state
 Anyway Ohio is the flower state
 New York is the key state.
 Bandana is the population state.

In the hay states of Pennsylvania and Arkansas
 I lay down and slept.
 The cross delirium tremens state of Mississippi
 Led me to further discoveries:
 Timbuctoo, for instance. And Ashtabula,
 The towel city. The wolverines
 Had almost faded off the towels, the frigid pallor
 Of the arctic sun was responsible."

"Isn't Montpelier the capital of the ditch state?
 I remember as a child reading about some bombs
 That had been placed on a tram.
 They were green and in a cone-shaped pile
 To look like a fir tree.
 Many people were fooled.
 Others in faraway places
 Like Aberdeen or the Shetland Islands
 Were unhappy about the affair.
 What can you do with people far away?
 Only those near me, like Bob,
 Mean to me what Uncle Ben means to me
 When he comes in, wiping a block of ice
 On a chipmunk dishtowel, his face glittering
 With the pleasure of being already absent.
 Or when someone places a cabbage on a stump
 I think I am with them, I think of their name:
 Julian. Do you see
 The difference between weak handshakes
 And freezing to death in a tub of ice and snow
 Called a home by some, but it lacks runners,
 Do you? When through the night
 Pure sobs denote the presence
 Of supernatural yearning you think
 Of all those who have been near you
 Who might have formed a wall
 Of demarcation around your sorrow,
 Of those who offered you a coffee."

The chariot moved apart
 And those who had been whispering
 Pulled away, as though offended
 By a sudden noise. Night grew clear

Over Mount Hymettus
And sudden day unbuttoned her blouse.
The travellers drew near a lake
Whose palm trees and chalets
Seemed indifferent, transparent
And so the trip stays
Close to hope and death. Dun lamps
Reveal a stone signpost.
We have lived here a long time.
The lips suggest a tragedy
No heart can make clear.
The glass blobs form an exclamation point.
The green shall not pierce your tippling sanctity,
The weather continues, the children are on their way to school.

Yellow curtains
Are in fashion,
Murk plectrum,
Fatigue and smoke of nights
And recording of piano in factory.
Of the hedge
The woods
Stained by water running over
Factory is near
Workers near the warmth of their nights
And plectrum. Factory
Of cigar. The helium burned
All but the man. And the
Child. The heart. Moron.
Headed slum
Woods coming back
The sand
Lips hips The sand poured away over
The slum and the fountain
Man and child
Cigar and palace
Sand and hips
The factory and the palace. Like we
Vote. The man and the rose.
The man is coming back—take the rose.

And scoot over car door
Back into pulp. The race reads print—
Trees—The man races to the print.
The child and the rose and the cigar are there at the edge of the fountain
“The bath of the mountains” in a way.
The factory to be screwed onto palace
The workers—happy
Lost memory lost mess happy
Opium rose
You cheat you are our face
Lost danger
Going close to the bowl you said a word
Me. You forgot the piano. It is
The one thing that can destroy us.

40/ The partridges and the wild fowl and the other game hens
Have gone to their nests near water undisturbed
The sunset stains the water of the lake,
Plectrum. There are birches in the trees,
White with fine black markings, like stalks.
Tears invade the privacy of private lives
In the house overlooking the park
The piano is seldom mute
The plectrum on the lawn vanishes
Tears invade the jealousy of the regent's bosom
Walking at twilight by the path that leads to the factory
The floor a pool. When the cigar
Explodes
The tears a fifth time of the workers pulling down the board through
the trees
Plectrum
Darkness invades the tears exploding in the bosom
Walking the little boy the enormous dog and red ball
In the house by the marshes
Where they gave up
Soldiers in blue
The merchant returns. The map
Shut up. Across the sea
Now in another way of life carrying the food
To the edge of the mouth
Pausing at the end of the lane the hips
Waiting cigar long ago
Plectrum two three
Before killing after coming so far
Day declines jealousy in the house by the park
Under the mill
The child falls asleep on the chalk breast.

Of bricks . . . Who built it? Like some crazy balloon
When love leans on us
Its nights . . . The velvety pavement sticks to our feet.
The dead puppies turn us back on love.

Where we are. Sometimes
The brick arches led to a room like a bubble, that broke when
you entered it
And sometimes to a fallen leaf.
We got crazy with emotion, showing how much we knew.

The Arabs took us. We knew
The dead horses. We were discovering coffee,
How it is to be drunk hot, with bare feet
In Canada. And the immortal music of Chopin

Which we had been discovering for several months
Since we were fourteen years old. And coffee grounds,
And the wonder of hands, and the wonder of the day
When the child discovers her first dead hand.

Do you know it? Hasn't she
Observed you too? Haven't you been observed to her?
My, haven't the flowers been? Is the evil
In't? What window? What did you say there?

Heh? Eh? Our youth is dead.
From the minute we discover it with eyes closed
Advancing into mountain light.
Ouch . . . You will never have that young boy,

That boy with the monocle
Could have been your father
He is passing by. No, that other one,
Upstairs. He is the one who wanted to see you.

He is dead. Green and yellow handkerchiefs cover him.
Perhaps he will never rot, I see
That my clothes are dry. I will go.
The naked girl crosses the street.

Blue hampers . . . Explosions,
Ice . . . The ridiculous
Vases of porphyry. All that our youth
Can't use, that it was created for.

It's true we have not avoided our destiny
By weeding out the old people.
Our faces have filled with smoke. We escape
Down the cloud ladder, but the problem has not been solved.

The experience of writing you these love letters . . .
Fences not concluding, nothing, no even, water in your eye, seeming anything
The garden in mist, perhaps, but egocentricity makes up for that, the winter
locusts, whitened
Her hand not leading anywhere. Her head into the yard, maples, a stump seen
through a gauze of bottles, ruptures—
You had no permission, to carry anything out, working to carry out the insane
orders given you to raze
The box, red, funny going underground
And, being no reason suspicious, mud of the day, the plaid—I was near you
where you want to be
Down in the little house writing you.

Though afterwards tears seem skunks
And the difficult position we in to light the world
Of awe, mush raging, the stump again
And as always before
The scientific gaze, perfume, millions, tall laugh
That was ladder though not of uncertain, innocuous truths, the felt branch—
To a ditch of wine and tubs, spraying the poster with blood, telegraph, all the
time
Automatically taking the things in, that had not been spoiled, sordid.

Where then shall hope and fear their objects find?
The harbor cold to the mating ships,
And you have lost as you stand by the balcony
With the forest of the sea calm and gray beneath.
A strong impression torn from the descending light
But night is guilty. You knew the shadow
In the trunk was raving
But as you keep growing hungry you forget.
The distant box is open. A sound of grain
Poured over the floor in some eagerness—we
Rise with the night let out of the box of wind.

There was no longer any need for the world to be divided
Into bunny, when he had chased the hare.
He had to be
Pressure, so disappeared from the air.
I understand . . . to accept the ball.
To inspire the painted wall
She limited the hall.

A mouse with crew-
Cut rang the bell, the wall
Fell into the sewer garden. Perhaps some football'll
Square you off, save you a minute
That he fell.

Was it only ten months ago
The general installed? Pine
Offered foreign . . . warmonger
Piloting a contraption
Above the dotted fields, seizes
The contrast. The branches
Urge his pain. He sees.
The trees is to be considered to him
Like we in the way you say saga.
Perfect, the emery wheel.
There was no reason to play. Pennies, these I can give you. I have nothing else,
and the air . . . I ought to, but I cannot, feeling the air and you there. I
cannot set you free, whispering only to be there.

I write, trying to economize
These lines, tingling. The very earth's
A pension. My life story
I am toying with the idea.
I'm perfectly capable (signature)
The kerosene white branches the stadium

There is no reason to be cold
Underneath, it is calm today.
For the moment, clement day
Observes our transactions with kindly eye.
There is no reason to suppose

16/ Anything of the kind will occur.
I oppose with all the forces of my will
Your declaration. You are right
To do so. The street catches auburn
Reflections, the start is here.
You may have been well.
You limit me to what I say.
The sense of the words is
With a backward motion, pinning me
To the daylight mode of my declaration.

But ah, night may not tell
The source! I feel well
Under the dinner table. He is playing a game
With me, about credits.
I have to check in the hall
About something.
The invitation arrived
On the appointed day.
By nightfall he and I were between.
The street rages with toil.
Can you let yourself, a moment, put down your work?

If only the phantom would stop reappearing!
 Business, if you wanted to know, was punk at the opera.
 The heroine no longer appeared in *Faust*.
 The crowds strolled sadly away. The phantom
 Watched them from the roof, not guessing the hungers
 That must be stirred before disappointment can begin.

One day as morning was about to begin
 A man in brown with a white shirt reappearing
 At the bottom of his yellow vest, was talking hungers
 With the silver-haired director of the opera.
 On the green-carpeted floor no phantom
 Appeared, except yellow squares of sunlight, like those in *Faust*.

That night as the musicians for *Faust*
 Were about to go on strike, lest darkness begin
 In the corridors, and through them the phantom
 Glide unobstructed, the vision reappearing
 Of blonde Marguerite practicing a new opera
 At her window awoke terrible new hungers

In the already starving tenor. But hungers
 Are just another topic, like the new Faust
 Drifting through the tunnels of the opera
 (In search of lost old age? For they begin
 To notice a twinkle in his eye. It is cold daylight reappearing
 At the window behind him, itself a phantom

Window, painted by the phantom
 Scene painters, sick of not getting paid, of hungers
 For a scene below of tiny, reappearing
 Dancers, with a sandbag falling like a note in *Faust*
 Through purple air. And the spectators begin
 To understand the bleeding tenor star of the opera.)

That night the opera
 Was crowded to the rafters. The phantom
 Took twenty-nine curtain calls. "Begin!
 Begin!" In the wings the tenor hungers
 For the heroine's convulsive kiss, and Faust

Moves forward, no longer young, reappearing

And reappearing for the last time. The opera

Faust would no longer need its phantom.

On the bare, sunlit stage the hungers could begin.

The Division was unsuitable
He thought. He was tempted not to fulfilling order written down
To him. The award on the wall
Believing it belonged to him.
Working and dreaming, getting the sun always right
In the end, he had supplanted the technician
With the bandage. Invented a new cradle.
The factory yard resounded
Filling up with air. Spring, outside
The window jammed almost shut, wafted its enormous bubble amidships.
Tell me, asparagus fern
Are you troubled by the cold night air?
The plane had passed him,
Bound for Copenhagen with smiling officers.
Lighter than air, I guess. I jest
Was playing the piano of your halitosis
A bridge into amber. Seven bargains popped into the sloop.
Venomously she aimed the pot of flowers
At his head—a moth-eaten curtain hid the fire extinguisher.

We all have graves to travel from, vigorously exerting
The strongest possible influence on those about us.
The children sleep—mountains—absorbing us into the greater part of us;
We had seen the sun dance.
Ribbons cover it—the carnival brought
The thermometer down to absolute zero.
People unknown in the depot
A lot of valuable medicine being stolen
Climate in your eyes. I have to tell
The doctor entered, a wet Limburger cheese sandwich in his hand.
He was crying. His little daughter, next to him
Was about fourteen years old. Her crying fit
Was not yet over. You could go out of the house
The saffron paving stones were aware of this
Pond leading down to the sea.
As though too much dew obscured the newspaper
A band of polyps decorating it
For the optician's lenses never told you
Until today, that is, how many crawfish

50/ I detest you. We slowly stoked the rusted platinum engine.
Only about three more kilometers now
Tabby had been notified. The ball of sperm
And then we . . . It too faded into light
An oriental thing, curved that lissome day might fit
There was rain and dew
You hanging on the clothes horse
Thought it funny the mushrooms
Water moccasins and Dutch elm disease.
If only pockets contained the auditorium,
He, the young girl in business,
The girl Samson told you about when they came to get him out
Unpacked the old Chevrolet—upholstery and such
The horse rocketing us into a nightmare world of champagne
You surprised more kinks. After all, a rabbit
Screaming paeans of praise—from mortar.

Frigid disappointment skins the wall of a bald world.
Release shadow upon men—in their heaviness
Siding with hours in their flight
Turning over the subconscious—and all fly
With him—the radio, astronomy lessons,
The broken pageant, the girls'
Dormitory.

All . . . All these numbers easily . . . Why . . .
Unwashed feet and then . . . typhoid fever . . .
The leading drains multiplied, then over ocean head
Is a dangerous feed broken easily.
The reeds came up to her, lying without life
Standing half-way to the shore. Then they came over and . . .

Calm clouds borne over. The reeds, not strife.
These were thoughts of happiness
In the dark pasture
Remembering from the other time.
The old man ignored.

These times, by water, the members
Balloting, proud stain adrift
Over the glass air.
See, you must acknowledge.
For big charity ball. The autumn leaves
Among lead crescents, and wig—

Never-to-be-forgotten conjectures
Concerning the originality
Caves and dynamic arches and the used green
Encrusted the tube.
The mirror, the child's scream
Is perplexed, managing to end the sentence.

The scissors, this season, old newspaper.
The brown suit. Hunted unsuccessfully,
To be torn down later
The horse said.
You called midway between the jaws,
Mediterranean bus strike
At the four corners of the world
She stood, stinking. The cart unleashed
Ashes over every part of the century;
Some of us were working—the cat.
You pill . . . on the porch
Workers bravo. Before the universe.

52 / Only a small edge of dime protected the issued utter blank darkness from the silver regal porch factory inscribed pearl-handled revolver raped gun to the ultimate tease next to the door fifth gum. Your Balzac open the foot scrounge lamp tube traffic gun. Gun is over, war banished, tottering lamp gun. Hic the perfect screw slow giggles to be sky raffia. The person or persons molested. These led directly to:

FIRST FUNERAL

The sky hopes the vanilla bastard
Axle busted over fifth dimwit slump.
The reason ejected. Impossibility of their purple paper trails.
Hold collar, basted.

SECOND FUNERAL

Candy rigors upset the train
From Boston to Newport.
I was reading *Vogue* in the car—suddenly
Cream or lace—to be manufactured this year like in loom.
The room in which the loom
Dispelled thunder, cracked tennis under the eaves. Gone to work.

THIRD FUNERAL

Hardly was believed New England eyes
At fast report, tacked up in factory
Before the holidays.
After the holidays
The jar filled rapidly . . .

FOURTH FUNERAL

So we sabotaged the car
The rangers loved. Not to protect
Is to give all, we found
Under the topical night.
The weeds, miserable, and yet, topmast,
The performance is worth knives.

We shall not call you
On that. Panorama. Over the glue garage
The sky was blue fudge.
The sky was white as flour—the sky
Like some baker's apron. Or the margarine
Of an April day. Pig. The sea. Ancient smoke.

After the New Year
The tide changed.
Green thorns flushed in from the New England coasts and swamps,
All kinds of things
To make you think. Oh heart
You need these things, leaves and nubile weeds,
I guess, ever present.
They changed the time
And we were supposed to be back an hour earlier.

SIXTH FUNERAL

The colored balls were like distant lights on the plaque horizon.
There was room for but one ball.

SEVENTH FUNERAL

The thrush of those who await the month
Of decapitated return, and thankless sight.
Through steering wheel
Brown woods or weeds
And brown-ribbed dress, violent
In the sun. The birds
And all your deeds. They bids.

EIGHTH FUNERAL

A glass of water in home
To where we had come out of the hole
Crying, the running water
Announced our engagement.
The dog ran over us
The ball with all his might.
We might escape, in the daylight
The barn of his personal loss.

NINTH FUNERAL

There was a slow rejoining of his
Original position, the maelstrom.
Lights were brought. The beds, sentenced.
The tulips grew redder. He smiled over
The desk. The persons abolished
Grew to stand in the tank his sin made.
—the vice-twins.

A passion of daisies real
The embossed white of the silver head.
Among the stars it is time
Going slowly down to where
You were asked not to participate, where
Hard mud trails reiterate
Brougham capital.

ELEVENTH FUNERAL

Stones. Loggia

The least astonished were the wetter veterans who had come to pray and practice, unaware as yet that the basilica's southern tip was submerged—you to whom I write, can you believe them this instant far from ideal palms? That the farewell was taking place? That's why the funeral décors—black gingerbread for the trip, I suppose will want something other than nauseating clear sea framed in window—to eat, I mean, just as our mind takes up the vases, deposit hard baked clay on hard mud or stone—the loggia in the picture. You see well, the perverted things you wanted gone in a group of colored lights all lucky for you. Besides, sometime the question will return—count on asking—the bald leader smile up at your dark window in the nothing sunlight—just because you correctly ask that one day and now nothing more, politeness and the broad seas.

The pest asked us to re-examine the screws he held.
Just then the barman squirted juice over the lumps.
It decided to vote for ink (the village).
There was surprise at the frozen ink
That was brought in and possibly rotten.
Several new lumps were revealed
Near Penalty Avenue. The bathers' tree
Explained ashes. The pilot knew.
All over the country the rapid extension meter
Was thrown out of court . . . the tomatoes . . .

The charcoal mines were doing well
At $9\frac{1}{2}$ per cent. A downy hill
Announced critical boredom for the bottler
Of labor tonic. It seemed there was no more
Steering-wheel oil or something—you had better
Call them about it—I don't know,
I predisposed the pests toward blue rock.
The barometer slides slowly down the wall
It has finished registering data.
The glass sanctuary repeated the panic
Of Morgan's Hill.

You knew those square doctrines had—
Come apart . . . the paper lining had gotten
Unpinned, or unstuck, and blue balloons
Poured out over the foul street, creasing
The original paper outside. The ladder failed.

These wonderful things
 Were planted on the surface of a round mind that was to become our present
 time.

The mark of things belongs to someone
 But if that somebody was wise
 Then the whole of things might be different
 From what it was thought to be in the beginning, before an angel bandaged the
 field glasses.

Then one could say nothing hear nothing
 Of what the great time spoke to its divisors.
 All borders between men were closed.
 Now all is different without having changed
 As though one were to pass through the same street at different times
 And nothing that is old can prefer the new.
 An enormous merit has been placed on the head of all things
 Which, bowing down, arrive near the region of their feet
 So that the earth-stone has stared at them in memory at the approach of an
 error.

Still it is not too late for these things to die
 Provided that an anemone will grab them and rush them to the wildest heaven.
 But having plucked oneself, who could live in the sunlight?
 And the truth is cold, as a giant's knee
 Will seem cold.

Yet having once played with tawny truth
 Having once looked at a cold mullet on a plate on a table supported by the
 weight of the inconstant universe
 He wished to go far away from himself.
 There were no baskets in those jovial pine-tree forests, and the waves pushed
 without whitecaps
 In that foam where he wished to be.

Man is never without woman, the neuter sex
 Casting up her equations, looks to her lord for loving kindness
 For man smiles never at woman.
 In the forests a night landslide could disclose that she smiled.
 Guns were fired to discourage dogs into the interior
 But woman—never. She is completely out of this world.
 She climbs a tree to see if he is coming
 Sunlight breaks at the edges of the wet lakes

And she is happy, if free
For the power he forces down at her like a storm of lightning.

Once a happy old man
One can never change the core of things, and light burns you the harder for it.
Glad of the changes already and if there are more it will never be you that
minds

Since it will not be you to be changed, but in the evening in the severe lamp-
light doubts come

From many scattered distances, and do not come too near.

As it falls along the house, your treasure

Cries to the other men; the darkness will have none of you, and you are folded
into it like mint into the sound of haying.

It was ninety-five years ago that you strolled in the serene little port; under an
enormous cornice six boys in black slowly stood.

Six frock coats today, six black fungi tomorrow,

And the day after tomorrow—but the day after tomorrow itself is blackening
dust.

You court obsidian pools

And from a tremendous height twilight falls like a stone and hits you.

You who were always in the way

Flower

Are you afraid of trembling like breath

But there is no breath in seriousness; the lake howls for it.

Swiftly sky covers earth, the wrong breast for a child to suck, and that,

What have you got there in your hand?

It is a stone

So the passions are divided into tiniest units

And of these many are lost, and those that remain are given at nightfall to the
uneasy old man

The old man who goes skipping along the roadbed.

In a dumb harvest

Passions are locked away, and states of creation are used instead, that is to say
synonyms are used.

Honey

On the lips of elders is not contenting, so

A firebrand is made. Woman carries it,

She who thought herself good only for bearing children is decked out in the
lace of fire

58 / And this is exactly the way she wanted it, the trees coming to place themselves
in her
In a rite of torpor, dust.
A bug carries the elixir
Naked men pray the ground and chew it with their hands
The fire lives
Men are nabbed
She her bonnet half off is sobbing there while the massacre yet continues with a
terrific thin energy
A silver blaze calms the darkness.

Rest undisturbed on the dry of the beach
Flower
And night stand suddenly sideways to observe your bones
Vixen

Do men later go home
Because we wanted to travel
Under the kettle of trees
We thought the sky would melt to see us
But to tell the truth the air turned to smoke,
We were forced back onto a foul pillow that was another place.
Or were lost by our comrades
Somewhere between heaven and no place, and were growing smaller.
In another place a mysterious mist shot up like a wall, down which trickled
the tears of our loved ones.
Bananas rotten with their ripeness hung from the leaves, and cakes and jewels
covered the sand.
But these were not the best men
But there were moments of the others
Seen through indifference, only bare methods
But we can remember them and so we are saved.

A last world moves on the figures;
They are smaller than when we last saw them caring about them.
The sky is a giant rocking horse
And of the other things death is a new office building filled with modern furniture,
A wise thing, but which has no purpose for us.

Everything is being blown away;
A little horse trots up with a letter in its mouth, which is read with eagerness
As we gallop into the flame.

I have lost the beautiful dreams
That enlisted on waking,
Cold and waiting. That world is a war now
The portable laugh eclipsing another place
The warrior's bonnet holds sand.
The blond headdress is soggy
The ray carried your picture away
If space could imagine a pilot
The clouds were rags, wheat the sun
A small dancer decorated the coverlet with gore
A perforated fountain assumed
That the center cravat was the right one
The one with peach halves and violets
And buzzing soda water
Out of the serene
Blackening with space, its blankness
Cast waterward, the grim engine
Chugging, denial at first
You see you cannot do this to me
Why, we were differing
The eyes and clitoris a million miles from
The small persistent tug.
The tree streamed with droppings
Mountain air the subject of our three conversations
The child skipped happily over
The western pages—even better than it is
Stones of day
Police formed a boundary to the works
Where we played
A torn page with a passionate oasis
Shall we ask them to
The kitty, the outgrown stone' keeps up
The grass and solid ovaries
A pineapple near
And the lumber over the rear plant
You especially not because you're known
That tree of noon—pretext of your roots
Are among several dopes
On the loony stock exchange
Near your dumb bank.

You often asked me after hours
 The glass pinnacle, its upkeep and collapse
 Knowing that if we were in a barn
 Straw panels would . . . Confound it
 The arboretum is bursting with jasmine and lilac
 And all I can smell here is newsprint
 The tea went down
 All went down easily
 He keeps coming back, the curse
 Of pliant dawns
 Braiding afternoons—a whistle be the result
 On some nights in their climate president
 His term packed with ice
 The sideboard burst under millions of candles
 And hope . . . a gray Niagara.

Under the crushed water on the rock
 Dove affects man . . . in his burden
 Compounded of cannibalism and hush
 Mice roar and an Ethiop
 Sprinkles lead beads over the clay babe
 Once the oxygen is removed the
 Arms can move freely again.
 The soldiers sigh comfortably
 In their garrison, you do not trust me any more.
 A rainy day brought us the truth
 The suffragette had proclaimed
 And the wax had shuffled
 Only beauty offered sin
 Out of the round and the oval
 Something to match the edges of dawn
 The house where it took place
 Pardon on the face of the tall wall
 That land burned season on it scum
 The fence removed and all the tile gone.
 Again, going up in a balloon
 Reading from the pages of the telephone directory
 The scooter and the Ethiop had gotten away
 The building was to be torn down
 A pleasant wink . . . you said the sun was setting
 And there were only more rollers,
 More Nile . . . In these moments I often think of the man

Who . . . payments acceded to the night
Of his claim a perfect universe
Onyx, imperturbable, moderate . . . you see the session was letting out
One came up to me
They veil the sky
Cast down in new purity, the cargo
A sky, the lever anyway
The plantation crew of three
Were never awarded. Mixed
With undistinguishable day, and night, the new moon
Turning with ash under the way
Crowds into the night stopped at fall
Lights stream undeniably away
The purgation is cheap. Blocked by a heavy truck
Shift your ballast, radiant
In gingham
The sheriff
Culled, all superior, and the grain
Disappeared forever, the haven
Which the ranch
Torn flower topping curious day.
A mast of all not eliminated
Fixing the way you smile
The sunbeams carried to me
The trail . . . stopped only where you overstepped
And libation. The answer had ended,
Clouds mounted swiftly, the furniture
Ages away by the torn page of the book
Forgotten in the sun
The pink moth close to its border
A millionth change
If we must go on
And the oasis in flames
The desert muted, the Nubians plunged in dreams
Scared by owls. You have to exact the forfeit
We change this concave block, the difference between us three
The peak guards mist his door
A table for three
The light goes out—it exudes
Your idea—perched on some utterly crass sign
Not the hardest either, but adoption is no way
There was calm rapture in the way she spoke

Perhaps I would get over the way the joke
Always turned against me, in the end.
The bars had been removed from all the windows
There was something quiet in the way the light entered
Her trousseau. Wine fished out of the sea—they hadn't known
We were coming relaxed forever
We stood off the land because if you get too far
From a perfume you can squeeze the life out of it
One seal came into view and then the others
Yellow in the vast sun.
A watchdog performed and they triumphed
The day was bleak—ice had replaced air
The sigh of the children to former music
Supplanting the mutt's yelps.
This was as far as she would go—
A tavern with plants.
Dynamite out over the horizon
And a sequel, and a racket. Dolphins repelling
The sand. Hosts of bulldozers
Wrecked the site, and she died laughing
Because only once does prosperity let you get away
On your doorstep she used to explain
How if the returning merchants in the morning hitched the rim of the van
In the evening one must be very quick to give them the slip.
The judge knocked. The zinnias
Had never looked better—red, yellow, and blue
They were, and the forget-me-nots and dahlias
At least sixty different varieties
As the shade went up
And the ambulance came crashing through the dust
Of the new day, the moon and the sun and the stars,
And the iceberg slowly sank
In the volcano and the sea ran far away
Yellow over the hot sand, green as the green trees.

Lugged to the gray arbor,
I have climbed this snow-stone on my face,
My stick, but what, snapped the avalanche
The air filled with slowly falling rocks

Breathed in deeply—arrived,
The white room, a table covered
With a towel, mug of ice—fear
Among the legs of a chair, the ashman,
Purple and gray she starts upright in her chair.

1.

To employ her
construction ball
Morning fed on the
light blue wood
of the mouth
cannot understand
feels deeply)

2.

A wave of nausea— numerals

3.

a few berries

4.

the unseen claw
Babe asked today
The background of poles roped over
into star jolted them

5.

filthy or into backward drenched flung heaviness
lemons asleep pattern crying

6.

The month of elephant—
embroidery over where
ill page sees.

7.

What might have
children singing
the horses
the seven
breaths under tree, fog
clasped—absolute, unthinking
menace to our way of life.
uh unearth more cloth
This could have been done—
This could not be done

In the falling twilight of the wintry afternoon all looked dull and cheerless. The car stood outside with Ronald Pryor and Collins attending to some slight engine trouble—the fast, open car which Ronnie sometimes used to such advantage. It was covered with mud, after the long run from Suffolk, for they had started from Harbury long before daylight, and, until an hour ago, had been moving swiftly up the Great North Road, by way of Stanford, Grantham and Doncaster to York. There they had turned away to Ripon, where, for an hour, they had eaten and rested. In a basket the waiter had placed some cold food with some bread and a bottle of wine, and this had been duly transferred to the car.

All was now ready for the continuance of the journey.

9.

The decision in his life
soul elsewhere
the gray hills
out there on the road darkness
covering lieutenant

there is a cure

10.

He had mistaken his book for garbage

11.

The editor realized
its gradual abandonment
a kind of block where other men come down
spoiling the view
wept blood
on the first page and following snow
gosh flowers upset ritual
a mass of black doves
over the scooter, snow outlining the tub
flowers until dawn

12.

that surgeon must operate

I had come across

to the railway from the Great North
Road, which I had followed up to London.

13.

the human waste cannibals designed the master and his life
robot you underground sorrow to the end
can unlack horsemen. Storm seems berries—
until the truth can be explained
Nothing can exist. Rain
blossomed in the highlands—a
secret to annul grass sticks—razor today engraved sobs.
The lion's skin—ears, to travel.

14.

Before the waste
went up
Before she had worked
The sunlight in the square—
apples, oranges, the compass
tears of joy—over rotten stone flesh
His dyspepsia uncorked—that's
leaf of the story
mitigated

15.

Absolve me from the hatred I never
she—all are wounded against
Zeppelin—wounded carrying dying
three colors over land
thistles again closed around voice.
She is dying—
automatically—
wanting to see you again, but the stone
must be rebuilt. Time stepped

16.

before I started
I was forced to flying
she said.

higher and higher on
next tree, am as wire
when canvas the must spread

17.

I moved up

glove
the field

18.

I must say I
suddenly
she left the room, oval tear tonelessly fell.

19.

Life pursued down these cliffs.
the omened birds
intrusion; skated, at night
clear waves of weather
fur you bring genius
over hell's curiosity
the librarian shabbily books on
You cannot illusion; the dust.
abstract vermin the garden worn smiles

20.

That something desperate was to be attempted was,
however, quite plain.

21.

Night hunger
of berry . . . stick

22.

"Beautiful morning for a flip miss," remarked the mechanic in brown overalls.
"Are you going up alone."

23.

"Then I'll take the bombs out," he said, and at once removed the six powerful
bombs from the rack, the projectiles intended for the destruction of Zeppelins.

24.

The tables gleamed—soft lighting

There was a certain pleasure in all this for him.
 The twelve girls wept. She willed him
 loveliest diamond of the tree; the old lawyer kept his mule there.
 They had gone. The weather was very pure that night like
 leaves of paper placed on the black—the opal
 crescent still dangled on the little chain—
 a pleasant memory of a kiss, completely
 given to recollection. Only
 faded water remained. The last memory left.

25.

She was dying but had time for him—
 brick. Men were carrying the very heavy things—dark purple,
 like flowers.
 Bowl lighted up the score just right

26.

water

thinking
 a

27.

A notice:

28.

wishing you were a
 the bottle really before the washed
 handed over to her:
 hundreds
 light over her
 hanging her
 you can remember

29.

Have you encouraged judge
 inked commentary
 approaching obvious battle
 summer night less ecstatic
 train over scream . . . mountain

30.

sweetheart . . . the stamp
ballooning you
vision I thought you
forget, encouraging your vital organs.
Telegraph. The rille—a page folded over.

More upset, wholly meaningless, the willing sheath
glide into fall . . . mercury to passing
the war you said won—milling around the picket fence, and
noise of the engine from the sky
and flowers—here is a bunch
the war won out of cameos.
And somehow the perfect warrior is fallen.

31.

They wore red
the three children dragged into next year
sad . . . gold under the feet.
sadly more music is divine to them.

32.

The snow stopped falling
on the head of the stranger.
In a moment the house would be dark

33.

mirrors—insane

34.

dying for they do not
the hole no crow can
and finally the day of thirst
in the air.
whistles carbon dioxide. Cold
pavement grew. The powerful machine
The tractor, around edge
the listless children. Good night
staining the naughty air
with marvelous rings. You are going there.

baited tragically
 This time the others grew.
 The others waited
 by the darkening pool—"a world of silence"
 you can't understand their terror
 means more to these people waste
 the runt crying in the pile of colored
 snapshots of fal in the wind
 that's the way we do it terror
 the hand of the large person falls
 to the desk. The people all leave.
 the industries begin
 moments puts on the silencer
 You crab into the night

The sheiks protest use of
aims. In the past
coal has protected their
O long, watchful hour.
the engines had been humming
stones of March in the gray woods
still, the rods, could not they take long
More anthems until dust
flocks disguised machine. The stone
the valentine couldn't save . . . Hooks

he ran the machine swiftly across the frosty grass. Soon he rose, and skimming the trees, soon soared away into the darkness.

From where Beryl sat she saw the glow
of the little electric bulb set over the instruments shining into
her lover's strong clean-shaven face, and, by the compass,
gathered that
they had described a half-circle, and, though

still rising rapidly, were now heading eastward in
the direction of the sea.

/71

38.

The roar of the engine, of course,
rendered speech impossible,
while the mist was very chilly, causing her to draw her brown
woollen comforter around her legs.
There was no sign of light anywhere below
—all was a bright black void.

39.

The few children
Seeds under the glare
The formal tragedy of it all
Mystery for man—engines humming
Parachutes opening.
The newspaper being read
Beside the great gas turbine
The judge calls his assistant over
And together they try to piece together the secret message
contained in today's paper.

40.

The police
Had been forgotten
Scarlet, blue, and canary
Heads tossing on the page
grunting to the coatroom
there was another ocean, ballads and legends, the children
returning to the past—head

41.

She was saying into the distance
It was a sad day
the riders drinking in the car
haze of trees behind
dummy woods
plans and sketches
soda, glasses, ice
bumped off
“with these strange symbols.”

the club had bought aperture

Their hidden storage (to you, murder)
but what testimony buried under colored sorrow
—the nerve

children called upon
assassination this racket.

He ran the ferret
backing him hard nest
The chil—
One day the children particularly surrounded
he had read about him.

Like a long room
Monsignor
pushed away it
studio artificially small
pine rounds

The last time she crossed close to Berck,
beyond Paris-Plage, she passed over Folke-
stone, and then over to Cape Gris-Nez
alone into the night

Or he hides bodies
stone night,
pleasant city, gray
hides
perfect dictionary for you
valentine not wanted storm under the
snow backed rubbers
The city hides, desolate
rocks snow tile hides
over the door marked "The literature

beginning veins hide the mind
robot—"—capped by all. release.

/73

48.

Then she studied her map, took her bearings
and, drawing on her ample gauntlet gloves
(for it had become chilly)
she followed a straight line of railway leading through Suffolk
and Norfolk

49.

I'm on my way to Hull
grinned the girl

50.

It was in German. The aviator and his
observer climbed out of the seats and stood
with Mr. Aylesworth, chatting and laughing.

51.

They are written upon English paper, and English penny stamps
are upon them . . .
they can be put into any post-box . . . They
mostly contain instructions to our good friends in Great
Britain.

52.

The rose
dirt
dirt you
pay
The buildings
is tree

Undecided

protest

This planet

53.

The vegetable wagon had not been placed yet
Scotchmen with their plaids—all the colorful
Photography, horror of all

That has died
 The hundred year old stones—deceived
 by the mind of these things—the stairs
 climbing up out of dark hollyhocks
 old, dirt, smell of the most terrifying thing in the world.

54.

“He is probably one of the gang.”

55.

mood seems the sort
 to brag
 end

56.

songs like
 You came back to me
 you were wrong about the gravestone
 that nettles hide quietly
 The son is not ours.

57.

Precise mechanisms
 Love us.

He came over the hill
 He held me in his arms—it was marvelous.

But the map of Europe
 shrinks around naked couples

Even as you lick the stamp
 A brown dog lies down beside you and dies

In the city an eleven year old girl with pig tails
 Tied with a yellow ribbon takes the trolley

All of this ends somewhere—the book is replaced on the shelf
 By an unseen hand

We are not more loved than now
 The newspaper is ruining your eyes.

58.

The professor—a large “S”

One kitten escaped

Take plane

or death by hanging

And naturally it is all over again, beginning to get tired you realize

59.

The real thing the matter

with him you see studio end

of day masked

you didn't see him—he went

escape is over on the lighted steps

“My blood went into this.”

Misunderstandings arise cathedral

twenty years later. catching sight of him

his baggy trousers the porch daylight

playing tennis before we realize the final dream is razed

Today, of course.

60.

Wing

Bostonian

and his comments

thirty-three years old the day

of his third birthday the legs

Lenin de Gaulle three days later

also comparing simple

61.

reflecting trout

62.

All of us fear the secret

guarded too carefully

An assortment

63.

she ran along the grass for a short distance

couple of beers

eats being corpse tables

64.

ice dirt
 five minutes
 get your money back
 the hole screamed
 two persons
 two cut flowers

65.

nothing is better than
 glowing coals
 The perfect animal
 during the summer, sleep of brine and ice

66.

She followed a straight line leading
 due north through Suffolk and Norfolk.

67.

over the last few years

 there is one terrifying
 wild
 the error of sleep
 love

68.

The straight line out of sight
 of beads
 decades cheapest
 the more post card
 "genius"

69.

because it is
 That is to say

70.

Her last dollar

71.

They must hold against
 The fire rain

or when sometime it seems
 upward, hands down
 against
 pilloried
 sell quickly took her bearings
 did not appear entirely
 upper hand of her
 a height of five thousand feet

72.

The village (using the new headache system) were cut
 With the stops running
 A French or Swiss
 had hit bottom and gotten back up
 wild margins are possible
 The gold a "call"
 options his life . . . flea

73.

A least
 four days
 A surprise
 mothers
 suppose
 Is not a "images"
 to "arrange"
 He is a descendant, for example
 The Swiss bank—a village

74.

Man come for one is humanity
 the lowest pickpocket helps

75.

Like the public,
 reactions
 from Crystal Palace

76.

A roar
 "sweetness and light"
 pickpocket—stem

and more scandalous . . . well, forgotten
 The snow is around storm
 He laughed lightly at cliff
 and used that term

77.

“Perhaps you’ve heard of her. She’s a great flying woman.”

“Oh yes,” replied the stranger. “I’ve seen things about
 her in the papers. Does she fly much?”

78.

applauding itself—wiser
 more gun I come from the district
 four times carrying a small,
 oval
 the movie was also
 in the entire crystal

79.

to stroll down Main Street
 the dignified and paternal image
 telegraph—magnificent

dump

porch

 flowers store
 weed local relatives
 whine

80.

multitude headquarters shout there
 Because there are no
 because the majority is toxic
 An exquisite sense—like pretzels . . .
 He was sent to the state senate
 wage conceal his disapproval
 The arguments situation lawyers worthlessness sullen cafeterias

81.

barcarolle

82.

The silencer. "Is he not . . ."

83.

Soon after noon, carrying a narrow,

84.

about her

85.

ghost of stone—massive
hangs halfway
polishing
whose winding
Strong, sad half-city
gardens
from the bridge of
stair
broom
recent past symbolized
hair banana
does not evoke a concrete image
the splendid

86.

nourished on the
railings of bare stone—

87.

Your side
is majestic—the dry wind
timeless stones. a deep sigh
dragged up with a piercing scream
the clean, crisp air
aging on the villas
little openings for her bath
facades of the—all alike, the hard rain
"the dignity of this fortress."

88.

the invaders

so bad just now
 go up and see the shabby traveller
 ordered a pint
 At half-past two, the visitor, taking
 his bag, set out on a tour of the
 village. An endeavor
 remained

rolls on them

at night

89.

This car has some private
 more than one cottage the chintzes were bright its
 brass candlestick forgotten
 twenty-five cents.
 could offer was a feeble

90.

I have a perfect memory and

the sky seems to pass
 a couple of them like a huge bowl

and encircle the earth

91.

flanked by his lieutenants—lemon—
 his chief outside
 “If I am wrong
 a fine sieve
 telephones I do not
 strong nature who wrote of him while starving himself

92.

to be dying, he gets them into magazines
 and some of them mangy and rabid
 hardly seemed necessary.

I was horrified. I felt sorry for him.
 No branch without . . .
 down to the lakes the ornamental

Hand in hand like fire
and in your souls

93.

A searchlight sweeping
picked up "The Hornet"
Hardly had he undressed when he
heard again that low swish of
"The Hornet" on her return from scouting circuit of the
Thames estuary
solidifying disguises

who died in an automobile accident
had developed a
then, imperceptibly

94.

The snow has begun to fall on Paris
It is barely noon

95.

Between the legs of her
Cobwebs the lip reads chewing
and taste seem uncertain;
powerless creating images
shut up and leave me . . . Hush! This
two men who have
most profoundly
the islanders

96.

Mr. Bean remained indoors
at the small boats
of our defences, our intentions

97.

out upon the lawn after a few months in the village

big
"Like some of my friends

Otherwise we'll chop off his head

98.

This was the third thing
another giant

99.

dark wool, summer
and winter

100.

gun metal—her right foot in both hands
things

101.

the doctor, comb

Sinn Fein

102.

dress

103.

streaming sweeping the surface
long-handled twig-brooms
starving
wall great trees

104.

blaze			aviators	
	out		dastardly	

105.

We must be a little more wary in
future, dear

106.

she was trying to make sense of
what was quick laugh
hotel—cheap for them
caverns the bed

Ere long a flare was lit
I don't understand wreckage

107.

blue smoke?	The steel bolts
It was as though	having been replaced
She had	by a painting of
the river	one of wood!
above the water	Ronnie, thoughtfully
	of the silencer

plot to kill both of us, dear.

pet

oh

it that she was there

108.

the bridge crosses
dragon ships
canal lock
was effect
There are but two seasons
the map of Paris
through the center of the sheet
character
sewers empty into under the
literally choked the river with
bodies
"on the coast, I think . . ."

passing over

109.

Magnificent trees—the old
chateau—he said he was
going home for their needs
only the other—
exchanged another meaning
here lately

110.

Dry, the bush
settling Everybody

knows him

close to the Thwaite
passing close to where

The bookshop
were crouched in conceal-
up a steep, narrow path
to the summit of Black Hill
recognized him
lavatory—dogging
his footsteps

out to sea

111.

Half an hour later

Ronald recognized him.

They suddenly saw a beam of intense, white light,
A miniature searchlight of great brilliance,
—pierce the darkness, skyward.

They now recognized to be a acetylene,
a cylinder mounted
upon a light tripod of aluminum
with a bright reflector behind the gas jet,
that the light began to "wink,"

three times in quick succession
the Morse letter "S."

Slowly the beam turned from north to south,
making the Morse "S." upon the clouds,
time after time.

Suddenly the light was shut off—for five minutes by

Ronald's watch no flicker was shown
Then suddenly, once again, the series of S's was repeated
in a semicircle from north to south

and back again.

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Another five minutes passed in darkness

Once more the light opened out and commenced
to signal the Morse flashes and flares,

“N.F.”, “N.F.”

followed by a long beam of
light skyward, slowly sweeping in a circle

the breath

TO THE SAME DEGREE

From the frozen yelps squirted lust
 Unavoidably but without waste, though certain risks
 Were being distributed. Water mains, you imitate
 Our positive statement, when through the disgusting air
 With mantle of leaves, possibly forgetting old
 Seizure, in some fishing village, the barbed leaves
 Close to the ground, in some automobile on the grounds
 Things contained in the universal consciousness:
 Woolf, brooks, books, the Carpathians, a caterpillar, rivalries
 Today we could see all the way to the ditch.
 The possibility of fastening a ball
 To anything, weary unexplored
 The river continued to pour out its volume of water
 Like an enraged smell. The horse disappeared
 With the cart. We were near a larger body
 Of water in the north
 To some factory of climate
 A fault deep in the earth
 Of manners unquenchable
 Or sold to be eaten out of hand
 The enormous cans
 You contaminated our layers.
 The wretch vanished. There is no more sirup, nothing to dominate
 As frogs will flock together, when the scudding
 Hares out of the west churned by the stain

Earnestly so-and-so
 The fresh lumps pointed
 To Valhalla, the oboes
 Torturing the hobo's visor
 The "Poet's Wife" ran aground
 The laxative had been
 Administered . . . on the grounds
 Of legality. Full ugly night
 With blistering blasts
 Fist of aloes, aground
 With only a certain amount of hair
 Cloves, you tax our
 Thorax weary from apes
 Ball
 Unexpected
 The tall stork approached
 This time the expenses were enormous
 And chirping bogs
 The anxious gardens' stare
 Agreement was possible. In the apartment fallen
 The tree began to take root. The promise of fire
 The sky and the storks began, the job
 Pleasure, earliest of the guests, prick
 With hand of flour execrating
 The keys. The pursar. With the time

Of erratic paradise, so fish will in schools
Close to the pond, rage, action
Contriving to will heartburn—in case of glare
Parenthesis uncle
A package of drought next door
Customers absorbed, mist getting redder
Two entries that day. Poured into one hole
And you remember to mark the exhausted shepherd
The marble of his Swedish copper forehead, and all that?

Pushing to the great bear
The boar—which do you prefer?
Some juice was served in glasses
And you could moisten your rusk.
This is perhaps the best time to point out
That I was alone—a large wheel.

Soon after they began to leave
In little groups first, then by tens.

the year books
 authored the heart bees—
 Beers over beads somewhat
 broken off from the rest
 Quit the tenement
 the person slides affect in excrement
 on the sides
 the janitor and cap, the flat
 over the trees
 years of patient
 on the patient, enamel
 sink
 washbasin
 Please, the pride of the
 the three
 threaded over, the fluke
 the midwinter flood
 we were how we liked to
 carry it
 the blood—full of
 and when the mediocrity
 cashed in
 the mediocrity
 fallen for the doom landing swivel
 to the next
 not to be free of
 and the comparison pointed to
 the exit light
 By frivolous sails
 you, that other, and the third one you were become by
 and the recent
 nuisance
 miscant eating
 the last time you on land to
 all the old ones eaten
 or carried away in marvel
 as though the pagoda
 and really carried away all
 the way shouted at
 crimson the day after

you removed the shin
having only forgotten the grave
but permanent as the night's infection
on the needle end
on that needle land

0/ THE SHOWER

The water began to fall quite quietly
As pipes decorate laminations of
City unit busses pass through.
A laborer dragging luggage examined
The wet place near a bug.
It sifted slowly down the sides of buildings flat
The permanent way to make a race.
So simple was the ally. Trying the lips
The spaced demons never breaking.
They imagine something different from what it is.

Just a fat man with sunglasses
Moving through shine—the uncle in the mirror—
As it is beginning again these are the proportions—
He lauds her with a smile.

Miles away in the country the performance included glue.
The abandoned airfield will have to have the imagination now
To be august, gray, against oneself

These things that are the property of only the few.

During the past few months, Biff had become quite a frequent visitor to Carol's apartment.

He never failed to marvel at the cool, corrected elegance of the place as contrasted with its warm, rippling, honey-blond occupant. The apothecary jars, Chippendale furniture,

and wall-to-wall carpeting were strangely out of keeping with Carol's habitual "Hiya good lookin'" as she came forward to greet him, wrapped in one of those big fuzzy bathrobes and drying her hair on a Turkish towel. Or were his calculations somehow awry? Was there, deep within this warm, vital-seeming presence a steel vein so thin as to be almost invisible? Or was this, too, a mistake?

Their whole conduct had been, up to now, not impersonal exactly, but utterly devoid of any recognition of sex-consciousness. In conversation they had "swapped backgrounds," as Biff called it. Carol, her eyes wet with tears at the picture of his isolation in the crowded rectory, had uttered a deep sigh at her own recital of being left for the first eight years of her life to the sole care of Patches.

With the unconscious dramatic heightening that always goes with a sympathetic audience, each of them, intensely serious and really moved, had lifted corners of the veil for the other to peep through. They had been very close to each other in attention, in sympathy, in response, but with none of the subtle emphasis which marks the recognized intrusion of sex. Carol was aware today, however, that Biff had suddenly become obsessed with a sense of her; that he had caught fire. She was aware of

vast excitement,

apprehension,

a mental

"Can I give you a hand?"

She gave a little cry that was silenced by mouth on

utmost tingling nerve

"Carol!" he said. Can this be the one time

????????????????????????????????????

She had known how from

Biff: The last Rhode Island reds are

"diet of hamburgers and orange juice"

Exactly what kind of perfection????????????????????????????????????

I see into fields of timothy

one

the others

time

change

'2 / ,,,,,,and they walked back,
small hand-assemblies

“What does it mean?????????????”

Carol laughed. Among other things,
till I've finished it. It's the reason of
dropped into Brentano's.

get some of the
a pile of these. I just grabbed one . . .

—Oh, by the way, there's a tele-

“See?” She pointed to the table.

Cornelia unfolded the piece of crude blue paper that is a French telegra.

#####

The mouth of weeds

marriage.” She shivered. “It's—it's a death!”

II.

The door of the studio slammed.

“Hullo, honey!” Cornelia said.

was the last practical from now on, whispers
leading into the night

flowers, moral turpitude,

She had had more than enough. Why, in Stone Age
vessels

But that doesn't explain. Her mind opened it-

Every tendril of thought,,,,,,

It sees through a magnifying glass

genius

a special aureole

Niagara of affliction. had learned this

heard it

into the

window the long platform at Oxford, and Carol lowered the

When the train stopped the army
You had nothing about it. That's no Bob!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!

A whistle blew shrilly
the slow evening
silver note
the main road automobiles
majestic stag-beetles, with a high, sweet hum
that moment for long
thoughts and low red voices
the mood was shattered
“twenty-seven” Just as that act changes
nerve-centers
birthdays—

She rose from the table abruptly. "You must smoke your cigar alone tonight. I—I'm going out in the car. She went upstairs and changed into a different pair of shoes and a sweater.

Jim was pouring himself another glass of port as she came down.
 "I won't be very long," she said. # # # # #

nodded. "Take care of yourself." She closed the door behind her and went down through the garden. A carnation struck her hand as she passed. She picked it, sniffed deeply, and put the stalk in her mouth. "Twenty-seven! Twenty-seven!" She went into the garage, a little house of wood, tucked into the bank at the edge of the road. It was Jim's car, a present from Carol. She had earned it in the year

following the exhibition, had learned to drive it at an automobile school in London, and had a special low bunk designed for Jim alongside the driver's seat. The carnation made a crimson splash against her cheek as she drove out and headed down the hill towards the main road. Up in the cottage Patches "Good 'eavens! Is that

For who dies
The crocus ideally
On life's playing field
The "never mind" rubbish
All, all fixed

running water
And the proper names,
blood out of courage
to fix
to feel
the stem of air

great, senseless knob
brownies ahead and the clutch. "Twenty-seven! Twenty-seven!"
sniffed loudly
the car window
listening car had ceased.

A whistle blew shrilly.